Stratoscan — Shark Tank results

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No deal: all 5 sharks are out. Five investor sub-agents grilled the pitch, one founder sub-agent answered only from the pitch file, then each shark decided. Every one of the 15 questions came back at least partly NOT ANSWERED.

The pitch: Stratoscan: a free, natural-language stock screener and 10-year backtester for US stocks, launched as a product people will come back to.

The panel

Shark	Decision	Offer	Why
The Tech Billionaire Shark	**OUT**	none	I asked who pays, who uses it and who covers the data bill, and all I got was zero users, zero revenue, a payment system you ripped out and a scraped Yahoo feed, so tell me, is this a business or a hobby, because right now it's a very well-tested hobby. For that reason, I'm out.
The Royalty Shark	**OUT**	none	I want a piece of every sale, and you've promised "free, forever," ripped out the payment system, and couldn't tell me what anyone would ever pay for or when the first dollar lands, so my royalty would be a percentage of zero. For that reason, I'm out.
The Customer Shark	**OUT**	none	I'm the customer, so would I actually buy this? You can't tell me who I am, what I'd cancel to make room for you, or how I get a result before I close the tab, and nobody but you has ever run one, so I have nothing to want. For that reason, I'm out.
The Numbers Shark	**OUT**	none	Show me the numbers? You can't: zero price, zero revenue, zero users, no bill at 10,000 users, no ask, and you ripped out the only thing that could ever charge a dollar, so there is nothing here I can put a payback date on. For that reason, I'm out.
The Skeptic Shark	**OUT**	none	I've seen this movie before: your whole pitch is "every number is correct," but those numbers come from an unofficial Yahoo scraper you don't control, your only backup is untested and legally can't show prices, and you couldn't name a single person who wants this over the free screeners they already use. For that reason, I'm out.

What would change their minds

• **The Tech Billionaire Shark:** Twenty real users outside your circle who ran a second backtest, plus at least five who said in writing what they would pay for it and how much.

• **The Royalty Shark:** A priced paid offer, live and taking money, with real customers paying for it, plus a line-by-line monthly bill at 10,000 users showing that revenue covers it.

• **The Customer Shark:** Ten strangers who already use Finviz or TradingView, each getting a first backtest in under 60 seconds on a deployed link, and at least half of them coming back to run a second one.

• **The Numbers Shark:** A one-page model with a real price, a line-by-line monthly cost at 10,000 users, and launched-user data showing what share run a second backtest and what share would pay that price.

• **The Skeptic Shark:** A signed, tested licensed data source that allows showing prices to users, with its monthly cost at 10,000 users, plus recorded interviews with real investors who say they'd switch from Finviz or TradingView to this.

Questions and the founder's answers

The Tech Billionaire Shark

Biggest worry: Nobody pays, nobody has used it, and the whole thing sits on free tiers and a scraped Yahoo feed that one growth spike or one terms change kills.

Q1. Who pays? Not "maybe later." You built a payment system and ripped it out. Name who pays and for what. Is this a business or a hobby?

> **A.** Nobody pays; payment system removed. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out who would pay, for what, and whether this is a business or a hobby.

Q2. Zero users, zero interviews, zero waitlist, running on your laptop. Who exactly is your user, and why do they drop the screener they already use for yours?

> **A.** **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out the specific target user and why they would switch.

Q3. Your price history comes from yfinance, which isn't licensed, and your backup licence forbids showing prices. At 10,000 users, what's your data bill and who covers it?

> **A.** yfinance today; the licensed backup is untested and bans showing prices. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out the data cost at 10,000 users and who pays it.

The Royalty Shark

Biggest worry: You've built a product with zero sales and a promise that it stays free forever, so there is nothing for my royalty to ride on.

Q1. I want a piece of every sale. You built a payment system and ripped it out. What will anyone ever pay you for, and when does the first dollar arrive?

> **A.** Nothing is sold; promised "free, forever." **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out what anyone would pay for and when the first dollar could arrive.

Q2. Your whole edge is "every number is correct," and it sits on yfinance, an unofficial scraper. Your licensed backup bans showing its prices to users. If Yahoo cuts you off, what's left to sell?

> **A.** The only backup cannot show prices. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out what the product offers without a displayable data source.

Q3. Zero users, not deployed, signups capped at 50 a day. What does this cost per month at 10,000 users, and who pays that bill?

> **A.** Today: free tiers plus a ~$2–3/month server. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out the monthly cost at 10,000 users and who pays.

The Customer Shark

Biggest worry: You've built a free tool for a user you can't name, and no one outside your laptop has ever run a backtest on it.

Q1. Who is the one person who opens this tomorrow instead of Finviz or TradingView's screener, and which of those do they cancel to make room for you?

> **A. NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out who the target user is and how Stratoscan compares with Finviz and TradingView.

Q2. Your kill metric is "runs a second backtest," but the first one takes minutes on cold data. Would I actually buy this? I'd close the tab before minute two. What gets a stranger to a result in under 60 seconds, and when?

> **A.** Under-60-second first backtest and no-signup trials are on the 15-day plan, not built; days 1–4 are done. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out how the speed target will be hit and a specific date.

Q3. "Every number is correct" rests on yfinance, an unofficial scraper, and your licensed backup can't show prices to users. When Yahoo breaks it, what do I see?

> **A. NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out what a user sees when yfinance breaks. The backup cannot show prices.

The Numbers Shark

Biggest worry: Price is zero, revenue is zero, customers are zero, and you tore out the payment system, so there is no math here for me to invest in.

Q1. Show me the numbers. You built billing and then ripped it out. What does a user pay, when, and why would anyone pay for a product you've promised is "free, forever"?

> **A.** No paid tier. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out a price, when charging would start, and why anyone would pay given "free, forever."

Q2. Everything runs on free tiers: 50 signups a day, 100 emails, 10 Finnhub keys. At 10,000 users, what's the monthly bill line by line, and who pays it?

> **A.** All free plans. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out a line-by-line monthly bill at 10,000 users and who pays.

Q3. Your kill metric is second-backtest rate, not revenue. What percentage do you need, by what date, before you'd charge, and how much are you asking me for?

> **A.** Second-backtest rate is the kill metric, with day-2 and day-7 return tracked. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out the target percentage, the deadline, the trigger for charging, and how much investment is being asked for and for what.

The Skeptic Shark

Biggest worry: Your whole position is "every number is correct," but the numbers come from yfinance, an unofficial Yahoo scraper you don't control, and your licensed backup forbids showing its prices to users.

Q1. I've seen this movie before: Yahoo changes something, the scraper breaks, and the "verified" backtester goes dark. What is your plan for the day yfinance stops working, given London Strategic Edge's licence won't let you show the prices?

> **A.** The plan is London Strategic Edge (untested; licence bans showing prices). **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out a workable plan for the day yfinance stops, including a licensed source that permits display and its cost.

Q2. You built a payment system and then ripped it out. Who pays for this when usage blows past ten free Finnhub keys and a 100-email-a-day cap?

> **A.** Nobody pays today. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out who funds paid Finnhub, email and other tiers once usage exceeds free limits.

Q3. You have zero users and no interviews. Name one real person who has asked for this instead of the free screeners they already use.

> **A.** Nobody can be named: no users, interviews or waitlist. **NOT ANSWERED:** the founder needs to find out through user interviews whether anyone prefers this to free screeners.

Homework: questions the pitch could not answer

• The founder needs to find out who would pay, for what, and whether this is a business or a hobby.

• The founder needs to find out the specific target user and why they would switch.

• The founder needs to find out the data cost at 10,000 users and who pays it.

• The founder needs to find out what anyone would pay for and when the first dollar could arrive.

• The founder needs to find out what the product offers without a displayable data source.

• The founder needs to find out the monthly cost at 10,000 users and who pays.

• The founder needs to find out who the target user is and how Stratoscan compares with Finviz and TradingView.

• The founder needs to find out how the speed target will be hit and a specific date.

• The founder needs to find out what a user sees when yfinance breaks. The backup cannot show prices.

• The founder needs to find out a price, when charging would start, and why anyone would pay given "free, forever."

• The founder needs to find out a line-by-line monthly bill at 10,000 users and who pays.

• The founder needs to find out the target percentage, the deadline, the trigger for charging, and how much investment is being asked for and for what.

• The founder needs to find out a workable plan for the day yfinance stops, including a licensed source that permits display and its cost.

• The founder needs to find out who funds paid Finnhub, email and other tiers once usage exceeds free limits.

• The founder needs to find out through user interviews whether anyone prefers this to free screeners.

The investors are language models and the offers are practice, not real money and not financial advice. Full session files: .shark/20261004-151819/ on branch claude/elegant-volta-6chp8v. Made with /shark, a free Claude Code skill by Alex Chen.